

to indictments found by a grand jury before that date or the procedure on the trial of indictments so found.

(4) This Act shall remain in force only during the continuance of the present war and for a period of six months after the termination thereof.

CHAPTER 5.

An Act to enable Ecclesiastical Services in certain cases to be omitted on account of the War.

[28th March 1917.]

BE it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :

1.—(1) No clerk in holy orders shall be liable to any penalty whatsoever, or to any action or other legal proceeding, in respect of the omission of all or any public services or duties in or in connection with any church, chapel, or other place of public worship, if the omission of those services or duties is for the time being authorised in writing by the bishop of the diocese ; and the bishop of the diocese shall have power to give and to withdraw, as occasion requires, an authority for that purpose.

Power to suspend temporarily ecclesiastical services.

(2) Where under this Act the services in any church, chapel, or other place of worship are entirely suspended, the Marriage Act, 1824 (which provides for the publication of banns and the solemnisation of matrimony elsewhere in the case of a church or chapel during the repair or rebuilding thereof), shall apply in the case of a church, chapel, or place where the services are so suspended in the same manner as it applies in the case of a church or chapel during the repair or rebuilding thereof.

5 Geo. 4. c. 32.

(3) The expression " bishop " in relation to the diocese of an archbishop includes the archbishop.

2.—(1) This Act may be cited as the Ecclesiastical Services (Omission on account of War) Act, 1917.

Short title and duration.

(2) The power to give an authority under this Act shall have effect only during the continuance of the present war and a period of three months thereafter ; and any authority given under this Act shall cease to have effect at the expiration of that period.